TCW 1103 · ENGINEERING COMMUNICATION SKILLS · PART 1

Workplace, Oral Skills and the Exam Spotter

Presentations and public speaking, introductions, job interviews, networking, promotion and pay talks, the C-suite, social media, study skills and exam tactics, then the exam spotter: ranked topics, examination vocabularies, a past-paper style question bank, model answers and the plan for Monday.

WHITEPAPER 3 OF 3

COURSE
TCW 1103 Engineering Communication Skills (Part 1)

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PREPARED FOR
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The spotter combines the lecturer's last-lecture emphasis (examination vocabularies, examination preparation, interview questions), the TCW 1103 topic list, the NUST TIE 1102 papers and the question patterns common to UZ, MSU and CUT communication skills papers.

Group 13 Study Board

1 Technical communication, drawings, IT and signs

Engineering drawing is called the universal language of engineers because it communicates shape, dimensions, tolerances, materials and assembly exactly, across language barriers, in far less space than words. It is also a legal and contract record, a design-checking tool (gaps show up as you draw) and, in CAD, the direct input to CNC machines and BIM models. Examples: a **reinforcement detail** tells the foreman bar sizes, spacing and cover; a **wiring diagram** tells the electrician connections and ratings; a **pipe network layout** tells the plumber levels and falls.

Information technology improves engineering communication through speed and reach (email, WhatsApp groups, video calls), shared models (cloud CAD, BIM), version control (everyone works from the current drawing revision), data dashboards and sensors (real-time monitoring of dams or traffic), knowledge bases and e-learning. Risks: network downtime, information overload, cyber-security, and the loss of non-verbal cues in text.

Warning signs communicate continuously, without words or a supervisor present, at the exact point of hazard, to workers of any language or literacy level. ISO 7010 colours: **red** prohibition or fire equipment, **yellow** warning, **blue** mandatory action (wear a hard hat), **green** safe condition or first aid.

2 Presentations and public speaking HOT

Plan: purpose, audience, occasion

- **Purpose**: to inform, persuade, instruct, entertain or inspire. Write it in one sentence.
- **Audience**: size, knowledge, attitude, expectations, language.
- **Occasion**: time allowed, venue, equipment, formality.

Structure: tell them three times

1. **Introduction** (10–15%): greet, attention-getter (question, fact, story), purpose, outline.
2. **Body** (70–80%): 3–5 main points in logical order, each with evidence or examples; signposts ("Secondly…").
3. **Conclusion** (10%): summary, key message, call to action, thank you, questions.

Delivery

- **Voice**: projection, pace, pitch variety, pauses, clear pronunciation
- **Body**: upright posture, purposeful gestures, eye contact across the room, smile
- **Notes**: cue cards, not a script; never read the slides
- **Appearance**: dress one level above the audience
- **Time**: rehearse with a timer; finish on time
- **Questions**: listen fully, repeat the question, answer briefly, admit "I'll find out"

Stage fright (glossophobia)

Prepare and rehearse; know your first minute by heart; arrive early and test equipment; breathe slowly; focus on the message not yourself; treat nerves as energy.

PowerPoint design: one idea per slide; no more than about six bullets of short phrases; at least 24 pt text; dark text on light background (or the reverse) with strong contrast; one font family; pictures, diagrams and charts instead of paragraphs; consistent template; no distracting animations; slide numbers; a title slide and a questions slide. A typical 8-slide outline: title → introduction → 4 content slides → summary → questions.

Visual aids help a diverse audience because they turn numbers into patterns, help people who are not specialists or not first-language English speakers, improve memory and keep attention.

Conference paper preparation: know the audience and time slot → structure (problem, method, results, conclusions) → design visuals → rehearse and time → prepare answers to likely questions → logistics (file formats, backup on a flash drive and in email, arrive early). **Analysing a speech**: purpose, audience,

organisation, delivery, visual aids, external barriers (acoustics, heat) and internal barriers (your fatigue, prejudice).

Face to face versus telephone: face to face gives non-verbal cues, stronger rapport and trust, immediate checking of understanding, use of drawings and samples, and suits sensitive or complex matters and group discussion; telephone is quicker and cheaper across distance but loses body language.

3 Proper introductions and remembering names

Introducing yourself

1. Stand, smile, eye contact, firm (not crushing) handshake.
2. Greeting + full name + role: "Good morning, I'm Tatenda Muzunze, a Part 1 civil engineering student at NUST."
3. One relevant detail or purpose.
4. Listen to their name and use it: "Pleased to meet you, Engineer Dube."

Introducing others

- Say the name of the **more senior / honoured** person first: "Professor Ndlovu, may I introduce Mr Chari, our site agent. Mr Chari, Professor Ndlovu heads our department."
- Give titles and one link between them.
- Use correct titles: Eng., Dr, Prof., Mr, Mrs, Ms.

Remembering names

Concentrate when you hear it; repeat it at once; use it in conversation; link it to a picture or someone you know; write it down afterwards; ask again politely if you forget.

4 Job interviews HOT

An **interview** is a planned, two-way, face-to-face (or virtual) conversation in which an employer assesses a candidate's suitability for a post and the candidate assesses the organisation. Types: **one-to-one**, **panel**, **telephone/video**, **group** (group discussion or task), **behavioural/competency** ("Tell me about a time..."), **technical**, **stress**, and **exit** and **appraisal** interviews inside a firm.

Before

- Research the organisation (projects, values, news)
- Re-read the advert and your CV; match skills to requirements
- Prepare answers to common questions (STAR) and 2–3 questions to ask
- Prepare documents: certificates, transcripts, portfolio
- Plan route; arrive 10–15 minutes early; dress formally

After

- Thank the panel; short thank-you email within 24 hours
- Reflect on what went well; follow up politely if no reply by the stated date

During

- Greet each panel member; wait to be offered a seat
- Upright posture, eye contact with whoever is asking, then the whole panel
- Listen to the whole question; ask for clarification if needed
- Answer with structure and evidence; 1–2 minutes each
- Be honest; never criticise past employers or lecturers
- Phone off; no slang; positive tone
- Close: thank them, confirm interest

STAR for behavioural questions

Situation → **T**ask → **A**ction (what *you* did) → **R**esult (with a number if possible).

Common question	What they want and how to answer
Tell us about yourself.	A 60-second professional pitch: present (studies), past (relevant achievements), future (why this post). Not your life story.
Why do you want to work here?	Show research: their projects and values, and how they match your skills and goals.
What are your strengths?	Two or three strengths relevant to the job, each with evidence.
What is your greatest weakness?	A real but non-critical weakness and what you are doing about it ("I used to over-check work; I now set time limits...").
Describe a time you worked in a team / handled conflict.	STAR story; show your contribution and the result.
Where do you see yourself in five years?	Growth within the profession (registered engineer, ECZ/ZIE), linked to the organisation.
Why should we hire you?	Summarise fit: skills + evidence + attitude + what you will contribute.
What are your salary expectations?	Research the range; give a range or ask about their scale; show flexibility.
Do you have any questions for us?	Always yes: "What would success look like in the first six months?" "What projects would I join?"

5 Networking

Networking is building and maintaining mutually beneficial professional relationships. **For a job seeker**: access to the hidden job market (many posts are filled through referrals), referrals and recommendations, information about companies and industry trends, mentors, interview practice and confidence. **For an employee**: faster problem solving through contacts, knowledge sharing and keeping skills current, visibility and career advancement, new clients and business, support and mentorship. **How**: professional bodies (ZIE student chapter, ECZ events), attachments, conferences, LinkedIn, alumni, lecturers; give before you take; follow up; keep in touch.

6 Promotion, salary rise and the boss's attention LIKELY

Asking for a promotion or salary rise

1. **Earn it and record it**: keep a log of achievements with numbers (cost saved, projects delivered).
2. **Research**: the role's requirements and the market salary range.
3. **Time it**: appraisal period, after a success, when budgets are set; not during a crisis.
4. **Request a meeting** in advance; don't ambush the boss.
5. **Make the business case**: what you have delivered and will deliver, not personal needs.
6. **Be specific**: the title or figure you want.
7. **Listen and negotiate**; accept alternatives (training, responsibilities, review date).
8. **Confirm in writing** and follow up; if refused, ask what you need to achieve.

Getting the boss's attention professionally

- Deliver excellent work on time, every time
- Bring solutions, not just problems
- Short, well-prepared updates; respect their time
- Speak up with ideas in meetings
- Volunteer for visible projects
- Ask for feedback and act on it
- Professional appearance and punctuality
- Use the proper channel; don't go over your supervisor's head

Communicating with the C-suite

Executives (CEO, CFO, COO) are short of time and think in money, risk and strategy. **Bottom line up front**; one-page summaries; numbers and options with a recommendation; link to company goals; anticipate questions; confident, brief, no jargon.

7 Communicating well at work; standards; social media

How to communicate well at work: choose the right channel; be clear and brief; listen actively; give and receive feedback constructively; respect hierarchy and confidentiality; be punctual and reliable; manage your tone in emails; confirm agreements in writing; stay positive and avoid gossip.

Workplace standards and occupational policies are the written rules that guide behaviour: code of conduct, health and safety policy (in Zimbabwe, NSSA's occupational safety requirements), dress code, ICT and social media policy, anti-harassment, leave and attendance, grievance and disciplinary procedures. They communicate expectations, protect staff and the employer, ensure fair and consistent treatment, and meet legal requirements. They must be communicated through induction, handbooks, notice boards, training and signed acknowledgement.

Social media skills: think before you post (it is permanent and public); keep a professional profile (LinkedIn) separate from personal accounts; never share confidential company information or photos from site without permission; respect privacy and copyright; no insults, hate or fake news; check facts; use groups (WhatsApp) for the purpose they were made; and remember that employers check candidates' online presence.

8 Study skills, exam tactics, talents, budgeting and planning

Study skills

- **Time management**: timetable, priorities, short sessions with breaks (Pomodoro, 25/5)
- **SQ3R reading** (Robinson, 1946): Survey, Question, Read, Recite, Review
- **Reading speeds**: skimming (gist), scanning (a fact), intensive reading (detail)
- **Note-taking**: Cornell, mind maps (Whitepaper 2 §8)
- **Active recall and spaced repetition**: test yourself; review after 1, 3, 7 days
- **Group study**: explain to others; past papers together
- Health: sleep, water, food, exercise

Essential examination tactics

- Read the **whole paper** and the instructions (how many questions, compulsory ones)
- Choose questions you can answer fully; start with your best
- Budget time by marks (3 h ÷ 100 marks ≈ 1.8 min per mark)
- Underline the **command word** and answer exactly that
- Plan each essay for 2–3 minutes: intro, points, conclusion
- One point per paragraph: define, explain, example
- Draw diagrams where they help; label them
- Leave 10 minutes to check; never leave a question blank

Identifying talents and creativity: reflect on what you enjoy and do easily; ask others for feedback; try new activities; use tools such as strengths inventories; keep a journal of achievements. Creativity grows through curiosity, brainstorming, mind mapping, tolerance of mistakes and combining ideas across fields. **Budgeting skills**: record income, list fixed and variable expenses, separate needs from wants, set savings first (pay yourself first), track spending weekly, review monthly; a common guide is 50/30/20 (needs/wants/savings). **The project planning process** (class presentation): goals and scope → schedule → resources → budget → quality → risk → communication plan; use SMART objectives and a RACI matrix (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed); watch for scope creep. **Finding a scholarship**: start early; search university, government and foundation sites; check eligibility; prepare transcripts, CV, motivation letter and references; meet deadlines; beware of scholarships that ask for payment.

9 Examination vocabularies HOT

The lecturer's last lecture listed "examination vocabularies" first. Prepare for both meanings: the **command words** in questions, and the **Health English vocabulary** handout (NUST PSBS) that the class was asked to translate into Shona and Ndebele.

Command word	What to do	Command word	What to do
Define	Exact meaning in one or two sentences	**Explain**	Make clear how or why, with reasons
Describe	Give the features or steps in detail	**Discuss**	Examine from several sides, with examples, then conclude
Distinguish / differentiate	Show the differences only	**Compare and contrast**	Similarities **and** differences
Outline	Main points briefly, no detail	**Illustrate**	Explain using examples or a diagram
Evaluate / assess	Weigh strengths and weaknesses, give a judgement	**Critically analyse**	Break into parts and judge each with evidence
Justify	Give reasons for a decision or conclusion	**Examine**	Inspect in detail, look at implications
State / list / identify	Name the points, no explanation	**Write short notes on**	A paragraph per item: definition + key points

Health English vocabulary (from the class handout)

Word	Meaning	Word	Meaning
abnormal *adj*	not normal for the human body	**deficiency** *noun*	a lack of something necessary for one's health
ache *noun/verb*	pain that won't go away	**dehydrated** *adj*	in need of water
acute *adj*	quick to become severe/bad	**dementia** *noun*	loss of mental capacity
allergy noun *allergic adj*	a body's abnormal reaction to certain foods or environmental substances (e.g. causes a rash)	**diabetes** *noun*	type of disease typically involving insulin deficiency
ambulance *noun*	emergency vehicle that rushes people to a hospital	**diagnosis** *noun*	medical explanation of an illness or condition
amnesia *noun*	a condition that causes people to lose their memory	**discomfort** *noun*	experiencing pain
amputation noun *amputate verb*	permanent removal of a limb	**disease** *noun*	a medical disorder that is harmful to a person's health
anaemia noun *anaemic adj*	occurs when the body doesn't have enough red blood cells	**dislocated** *adj*	when a bone is temporarily separated from its joint
antibiotics *noun*	medication that kills bacteria and cures infections	**emergency** *noun*	a medical problem that needs immediate attention
anti-depressant *noun*	medication that helps relieve anxiety and sadness	**ER (emergency room)** *noun*	the hospital room used for treating patients with immediate and life-threatening injuries
appointment *noun*	a scheduled meeting with a medical professional	**external** *adj*	on the outside
arthritis *noun*	a disease that causes the joints to become swollen and crippled	**false negative** *noun adj*	a test that incorrectly comes back negative
asthma (attack) *noun*	a condition that causes a blockage of the airway and makes it difficult for a person to breathe	**family history** *noun*	medical background of a person's family members
bacteria *noun*	a disease-causing organism	**fatal** *adj*	causing death
bedsore *noun*	wounds that develop on a patient's body from lying in one place for too long	**fever noun** *feverish adj*	higher than normal body temperature
benign *adj*	not harmful (not cancerous)	**flu (influenza)** *noun*	many types of respiratory or intestinal infections passed on through a virus
biopsy *noun*	removal of human tissue in order to conduct certain medical tests	**fracture noun** *fractured adj*	broken or cracked bone

Word	Meaning	Word	Meaning
blood count *noun*	the amount of red and white blood cells a person has	**germ** *noun*	a micro-organism, especially one that causes disease
blood donor *noun*	a person who gives blood to a blood bank or other person	**genetic** *adj*	a medical condition or physical feature that is passed on in the family
blood pressure *noun*	the rate at which blood flows through the body (high/low)	**growth** *noun*	a ball of tissue that grows bigger than normal, either on or under the skin
brace *noun*	a device that holds injured body parts in place	**heart attack** *noun*	instance in which blood stops pumping through the heart
breech *adj*	position of an unborn baby in which the feet are down and the head is up	**HIV** *noun*	the virus that infects the human T-cells and leads to AIDS
broken *adj*	a bone that is divided in two or more pieces as a result of an injury	**hives** *noun*	bumps that appear on the surface of the skin during an allergic reaction
bruise noun *bruised adj*	injured body tissue that is visible underneath the skin	**illness noun** *ill adj*	general term for any condition that makes a person feel sick for a certain period of time
Caesarean section, C-section *noun*	procedure that involves removing a baby from its mother through an incision in the woman's lower abdomen	**immune system** *noun*	the parts of the body that fight diseases, infections, and viruses
cancer *noun*	disease caused by the uncontrollable growth of cells	**immunization noun** *immunize verb*	an injection that protects against a specific disease
cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) *noun*	restoring a person's breath and circulation	**incision** *noun*	cut in the body made during surgery
cast *noun*	a hard bandage that is wrapped around a broken bone to keep it in place	**inconclusive** *adj*	unclear
chapel, chapeline *noun*	a place where loved ones can go to pray for a patient's recovery; a priest who visits patients in the hospital	**infant** *noun*	young baby
chemotherapy *noun*	type of treatment used on cancer patients	**infection noun** *infected adj*	diseased area of the body (viral or bacterial)
chickenpox *noun*	a virus commonly contracted by children, characterized by itchy spots all over the body	**inflamed** *adj*	appearance (red and swollen) of an injured body part
coroner *noun*	a person who determines the cause of death after a person dies	**injury** *noun*	damage to the body
critical condition *noun*	requiring immediate and constant medical attention	**intensive care unit (ICU)** *noun*	section of the hospital where patients get constant attention and doctors rely on specialized equipment
crutches *noun*	objects that people with injured legs or feet use to help them walk	**internal** *adj*	under the skin, inside the organs
cyst *noun*	a sac in the body-tissue filled with fluid (sometimes diseased)	**itchy** *adj*	feeling discomfort on the skin's surface
deaf *adj*	unable to hear	**IV** *noun*	a tube that pumps liquids and medication into a patient's body

The handout continues to Z in later lectures. Learn the meaning, part of speech and one example sentence for each word; the class exercise is to give the Shona and Ndebele equivalents.

10 The exam spotter

How the ranking was made: (1) the lecturer's emphasis in the final lecture; (2) the TCW 1103 presentation topic list, which is the syllabus; (3) the NUST TIE 1102 papers (Dec 2014, Aug 2015), whose questions recur; (4) the topics that recur on UZ, MSU and CUT communication skills papers (communication process, barriers, listening, reading and note-making, academic writing and referencing, reports, letters and memos, meetings, presentations, CV and interviews). Their library papers could not be opened from here, so the bank below is written in their style, not copied from them.

#	Topic	Chance	Why	Where
1	**Communication process and elements (diagram)**	HOT	Opens most papers; NUST Dec 2014 Q1	WP1 §2–3
2	**Barriers and how to overcome them**	HOT	Every university; class topic	WP1 §6
3	**Job interviews and interview questions**	HOT	Final lecture; two class topics	WP3 §4
4	**Examination vocabularies / exam preparation**	HOT	Final lecture; "Essential exam tactics"	WP3 §8–9
5	**Hearing vs listening; active listening**	HOT	Three class topics; UZ/MSU/CUT staple	WP1 §8
6	**Meetings: chair vs secretary, notice vs agenda, minutes**	HOT	Four class topics; NUST Dec 2014 Q3	WP2 §9–11
7	**The memo** (theory and writing task)	HOT	NUST Aug 2015 Q6; two class topics	WP2 §3
8	**Non-verbal communication, kinesics, appearance**	HOT	NUST Aug 2015 Q4; three class topics	WP1 §4
9	**Seven C's**	LIKELY	NUST Aug 2015 Q5 (20 marks)	WP1 §7
10	**Reports: definition, types, purposes, writing one**	LIKELY	Class topic; all universities	WP2 §7
11	**Presentations, public speaking, PowerPoint**	LIKELY	Class topic; NUST Aug 2015 Q6–7	WP3 §2
12	**Letters: complaint, motivation; CV**	LIKELY	Two class topics	WP2 §4–6
13	**Referencing (Harvard/APA), plagiarism**	LIKELY	NUST Dec 2014 Q5, Aug 2015 Q3	WP2 §12
14	**Assertiveness; manipulators; put-downs**	LIKELY	Four class topics	WP1 §9
15	**Conflict resolution; Kurt Lewin**	LIKELY	Two class topics	WP1 §11
16	**Organisational channels and directions; PR**	LIKELY	NUST both papers; class topics	WP1 §5
17	**Emotional intelligence; self-regulation**	POSSIBLE	Class topics	WP1 §10
18	**Leadership theories; transformational**	POSSIBLE	Class topics	WP1 §12
19	**Networking; promotion; salary rise; C-suite**	POSSIBLE	Several class topics	WP3 §5–6
20	**Drawing, IT, signs; social media; standards**	POSSIBLE	NUST papers; class topics	WP3 §1, §7

IF YOU ONLY HAVE ONE EVENING

Learn the diagram (WP1 Fig. 1), barriers with remedies, hearing vs listening and the five skills, the memo format, chair vs secretary, notice vs agenda, the interview table, and the command words. That covers the top eight topics.

11 Question bank: paragraph and essay questions

Whitepapers 1 and 2 each end with ten essay questions. These add short paragraph questions (2–5 marks each, "write short notes") and further essays across the whole course.

SECTION A STYLE · SHORT PARAGRAPH ANSWERS

1. Define communication and state three purposes of communication in an engineering firm. [5]
2. Explain the term "noise" and give one example of each of three types. [4]
3. Distinguish between formal and informal (grapevine) communication. [4]
4. What is feedback, and why is it important? [3]
5. Explain proxemics and chronemics, with an example of each. [4]
6. Give four differences between hearing and listening. [4]
7. Write short notes on: (a) quorum (b) agenda (c) minutes (d) AOB (e) casting vote. [5]
8. State five items found in the heading of a memo. [5]
9. Explain the difference between "Yours faithfully" and "Yours sincerely". [2]
10. List the sections of a formal report in the correct order. [5]
11. Define plagiarism and give three ways to avoid it. [4]
12. Explain the STAR technique for answering interview questions. [4]
13. Give four characteristics of an assertive communicator. [4]
14. Name the five components of emotional intelligence. [5]
15. Explain the meaning of these examination words: discuss, outline, compare and contrast, evaluate. [4]
16. Give the meaning of: benign, biopsy, diagnosis, inconclusive, acute. [5]
17. State the meaning of the four ISO safety sign colours. [4]
18. Give four benefits of networking for a job seeker. [4]

SECTION B STYLE · ESSAYS [20 MARKS EACH]

19. Discuss how a candidate should prepare for, behave during and follow up after a job interview.
20. Identify five questions commonly asked at job interviews and explain how a graduate engineer should answer each.
21. Discuss the essential examination preparation strategies and tactics a first-year engineering student should use.
22. Explain how you would plan, structure and deliver a 15-minute presentation on the importance of water conservation to a rural community.
23. Describe the qualities of an effective PowerPoint presentation and prepare a slide outline on "Safety on construction sites".
24. Discuss the benefits of networking for (a) a job seeker and (b) an employee.
25. Explain how an employee should ask for a promotion or a salary rise professionally.
26. "Engineering drawing is the language of engineers." Discuss, with examples from two branches of engineering.
27. Discuss the importance of information technology in engineering communication, and its dangers.
28. Discuss the responsible use of social media by engineering professionals.
29. Explain the purpose of workplace standards and occupational policies and how they should be communicated to employees.
30. Explain how an employee should conduct themselves in a disciplinary meeting.

12 Two full model answers

MODEL ESSAY · Q19 PREPARING FOR, BEHAVING DURING AND FOLLOWING UP A JOB INTERVIEW [20]

A job interview is a planned, two-way conversation in which an employer assesses whether a candidate suits a post and the candidate assesses whether the organisation suits them. Success depends on what the candidate does before, during and after it.

Before the interview, the candidate should research the organisation: its projects, clients, values and recent news, so that answers can be linked to what the employer does. For a civil engineering firm, this means knowing whether it designs roads, water schemes or buildings. The candidate should re-read the advert and their CV and prepare evidence for each requirement, using the STAR method (situation, task, action, result) for questions such as "Tell us about a time you solved a problem". Documents (certificates, transcripts, portfolio of drawings) should be ready, formal clothes prepared and the route planned so that they arrive ten to fifteen minutes early.

During the interview, first impressions matter: a confident greeting to each panel member, a firm handshake, and waiting to be offered a seat. Non-verbal communication should support the words: upright posture, steady eye contact with the questioner and then the whole panel, and calm hands. The candidate should listen to the whole question, ask for clarification when unsure, and answer briefly with evidence rather than general claims; for example, "I led a team of four that surveyed the campus road and produced the longitudinal section on time" is stronger than "I am a team player". Honesty is essential, and past employers or lecturers should never be criticised. At the end the candidate should ask one or two prepared questions, such as which projects a new graduate would join, and thank the panel.

After the interview, a short thank-you email within 24 hours shows courtesy and keeps the candidate in the panel's mind. The candidate should reflect on which answers were weak and improve them, and if no reply comes by the stated date, follow up politely by email or phone.

In conclusion, an interview is won mostly by preparation: research, evidence and rehearsal produce confident, relevant answers, while professional behaviour and a courteous follow-up show the communication skills an employer is looking for.

MODEL ESSAY OUTLINE · Q21 EXAMINATION PREPARATION AND TACTICS [20]

Intro (2): exams test understanding under time pressure; success needs long-term preparation and tactics on the day. **Preparation** (8): study timetable from the exam date backwards; SQ3R and active recall instead of re-reading; past papers under timed conditions; group discussion; summary sheets and diagrams; sleep, food and exercise. **On the day** (8): arrive early with materials; read the whole paper and instructions; choose questions; budget time by marks; underline command words; plan each answer; one point per paragraph with an example; diagrams labelled; ten minutes to check. **Conclusion** (2): "Plan, practise, pace."

13 The plan from now to Monday

Day	Morning	Afternoon	Evening
Thu 22 Oct	—	—	Skim all three whitepapers; mark weak topics
Fri 23 Oct	WP1 §1–7: draw the diagram from memory three times	Barriers + 7 C's: write one 20-mark answer each	Listening, non-verbal: short-note drill

Day	Morning	Afternoon	Evening
Sat 24 Oct	WP2: memo, letters, report formats (write each once)	Meetings, chair vs secretary, terms	Referencing drill; group meeting to swap model answers
Sun 25 Oct	WP3: interviews, presentations, workplace topics	Timed mock: any 4 essays from the banks in 3 hours	Vocabulary and command words; light review; sleep early
Mon 26 Oct	Read the summary boxes only. Eat, arrive early, read the whole paper, plan before writing, check at the end.		

THE ANSWER FORMULA THAT WINS MARKS

Define → Explain → Example (engineering) → Link back to the question. Intro with a definition, one point per paragraph, a labelled diagram where it helps, and a two-line conclusion. Pair every problem with a solution. Use names and dates of theorists where you know them. Write neatly; leave a line between paragraphs.

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TCW 1103 class presentations (2026): Chiworeso, S. *The project planning process*; and the lecturer's topic list (interviews, networking, promotion, salary rise, C-suite, social media, study skills, exam tactics, scholarships, budgeting, introductions, appearance).